SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

30 May 2022 · Shift 2

84 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 16 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 23 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Clamour

(A) Quiet
(B) Complaint
(C) Babble
(D) Danger

Q.3

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The thief / entered the house, / in the middle of the night, / quiet.

(A) The thief
(B) in the middle of the night
(C) entered the house
(D) quiet

Q.4

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them contains a grammatical error. Select the option that has the error. He is such an untruthful man, that no one will believing him.

(A) will believing him
(B) He is such
(C) that no one
(D) an untruthful man,

Q.5

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. The sweet and bitter memories of her past “make her weak and sad.”

(A) ought to make her pallid and unhappy
(B) had to make her pale and unhappy
(C) must make her pastel and unhappy
(D) made her feeble and unhappy

Q.6

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Have a soft spot for someone

(A) To argue something with no effect
(B) To like someone a lot
(C) To show the true nature of someone
(D) To resolve a problem successfully

Q.7

In the following passage, a word has been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. In a _____ move, the robbers chose their next place of attack over 255 km away from the locations they had earlier _____ in Dewas.

(A) righteous, incorporated
(B) noble, decided
(C) shrewd, targeted
(D) corrupt, vanished

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Reconnoitre

(A) Glance
(B) Disclaim
(C) Inspect
(D) Overlook

Q.9

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Rescind

(A) Revoke
(B) Sign
(C) Validate
(D) Accredit

Q.10

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. The thieves were caught by the police.

(A) The police was caught the thieves.
(B) The police were caught the thieves.
(C) The police had caught the thieves.
(D) The police caught the thieves.

Q.11

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Pull the plug

(A) End something
(B) Distract someone
(C) Launch something
(D) Annoy someone

Q.12

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Possession
(B) Jealous
(C) Suspecious
(D) Luxurious

Q.13

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. One expects better behaviour from a senior student.

(A) Better behaviour was expected from senior student.
(B) As a senior student you need to behave.
(C) Better behaviour is expected from a senior student.
(D) Senior student behaviour is expected better.

Q.14

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. One morning the Giant was lying awake in bed when he heard some lovely music. B. Then the Hail stopped dancing over his head, and the North Wind ceased roaring, and a delicious perfume came to him through the open casement. “I believe the Spring has come at last,” said the Giant; and he jumped out of bed and looked out. C. It was really only a little linnet singing outside his window, but it was so long since he had heard a bird sing in his garden that it seemed to him to be the most beautiful music in the world. D. It sounded so sweet to his ears that he thought it must be the King’s musicians passing by.

(A) ADCB
(B) BACD
(C) BADC
(D) ACDB

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. At loggerheads

(A) In one’s absence
(B) At mercy
(C) Disagreeing with
(D) To write down

Q.17

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A journey undertaken by a group of people with a particular purpose, especially that of exploration or research.

(A) Voyage
(B) Expedition
(C) Sojourn
(D) Pilgrimage

Q.18

Select the correct homonym from the given options to fill in the blank. She couldn't eat the_____ pizza by herself

(A) whole
(B) heal
(C) hole
(D) haul

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. "I am watching" a movie, when my mother came into the room.

(A) I watched a movie
(B) I was watching
(C) I would be watching
(D) No substitution required

Q.20

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The notice / that the office / posted over the wall / is very appropriate.

(A) that the office
(B) posted over the wall
(C) The notice
(D) is very appropriate

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The contract (1) _____ the author and the reader is a game. And the game is one of the greatest inventions (2) _____ Western civilisation: the game of telling stories, inventing characters and creating the (3) _____ paradise of the individual, from whence no one can be expelled (4) _____, in a novel, no one owns the truth and everyone has the right to be (5) _____ and understood.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) as
(B) between
(C) before
(D) beside

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The contract (1) _____ the author and the reader is a game. And the game is one of the greatest inventions (2) _____ Western civilisation: the game of telling stories, inventing characters and creating the (3) _____ paradise of the individual, from whence no one can be expelled (4) _____, in a novel, no one owns the truth and everyone has the right to be (5) _____ and understood.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) in
(B) of
(C) since
(D) about

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The contract (1) _____ the author and the reader is a game. And the game is one of the greatest inventions (2) _____ Western civilisation: the game of telling stories, inventing characters and creating the (3) _____ paradise of the individual, from whence no one can be expelled (4) _____, in a novel, no one owns the truth and everyone has the right to be (5) _____ and understood.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) plausible
(B) imaginary
(C) drastic
(D) transparent

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The contract (1) _____ the author and the reader is a game. And the game is one of the greatest inventions (2) _____ Western civilisation: the game of telling stories, inventing characters and creating the (3) _____ paradise of the individual, from whence no one can be expelled (4) _____, in a novel, no one owns the truth and everyone has the right to be (5) _____ and understood.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) beside
(B) across
(C) beyond
(D) because

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The contract (1) _____ the author and the reader is a game. And the game is one of the greatest inventions (2) _____ Western civilisation: the game of telling stories, inventing characters and creating the (3) _____ paradise of the individual, from whence no one can be expelled (4) _____, in a novel, no one owns the truth and everyone has the right to be (5) _____ and understood.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) prejudiced
(B) neglected
(C) heard
(D) removed

General Intelligence 19 questions

Q.1

In a certain code language, ‘PULSE’ is written as ‘QTMRF’ and ‘HEART’ is written as ‘IDBQU’. How will ‘LIVER’ be written in that language?

(A) KJWFS
(B) MHWDS
(C) MJUFS
(D) MKWFQ

Q.2

If 13 September 2003 is a Saturday, then what will be the day of the week on 14 February 2005?

(A) Friday
(B) Wednesday
(C) Monday
(D) Saturday

Q.3

In a certain code language, 'GRAPES' is written as 'EPYNCQ' and ‘ROSE’ is written as ‘PMQC’. How will 'SAGE' be written in that language?

(A) QYCE
(B) CYEQ
(C) QEYC
(D) QYEC

Q.4

Select the option that is related to the third number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the sixth number is related to the fifth number. 9 : 17 :: 22 : ? :: 30 : 59

(A) 22
(B) 56
(C) 43
(D) 72

Q.5

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 67, 79, 64, ?, 61, 85

(A) 82
(B) 84
(C) 80
(D) 83

Q.6

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 2, 26, ?, 170, 290, 442

(A) 50
(B) 37
(C) 65
(D) 82

Q.8

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 12,37,114,347,1048,?

(A) 3252
(B) 3153
(C) 3253
(D) 3152

Q.9

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. ABILITY : ITYLABI :: INSTEAD : EADTINS :: ENGLISH : ?

(A) ISHLENG
(B) LISHNGE
(C) ESHLING
(D) IHSLEGN

Q.10

If I denotes ‘÷’, J denotes ‘×’, K denotes ‘–’ and L denotes ‘+’, then what will come in place of ‘?’ in the following equation? 15 L (3 J 9) K (12 J 2) L (189 I 9) L 29 = ?

(A) 72
(B) 65
(C) 62
(D) 68

Q.13

Select the option that represents the letters that, when placed from left to right in the blanks, will complete the letter series. D _ R X E C M R _ E _ M R X _ A M _ X E

(A) B X M E R
(B) E B X M R
(C) M X B E R
(D) X M B E R

Q.14

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 2168,1979,1790,1601,1412,?

(A) 1223
(B) 1301
(C) 1212
(D) 1179

Q.15

Select the option that is related to the fifth word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word and the fourth word is related to the third word. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must NOT be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word) Bear : Cub :: Owl : Owlet :: Deer : ?

(A) Fawn
(B) Pup
(C) Calf
(D) Foal

Q.16

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 4 : 31::7 : 223::6 : ?

(A) 137
(B) 133
(C) 123
(D) 131

Q.18

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 16*4*8*10*2*16

(A) ×, ÷,−,+, =
(B) −,÷,+,×, =
(C) ÷,+,×,−, =
(D) ÷,−,+, ×, =

Q.19

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? RJGZ, NQWM, ?, FECM, BLSZ

(A) JXMZ
(B) KQDZ
(C) KWMZ
(D) JWZM

Q.20

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given number series? 209, 318, 427, 536, ?, 754

(A) 655
(B) 645
(C) 664
(D) 635

Q.23

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 48*6*17*3*12*5*1

(A) ×,−,=,+,×,+
(B) ÷,+,−,=,+,×
(C) +,=,−,×,+,÷
(D) ÷,+,×,=,×,−

Q.24

Select the correct option that indicates the arrangement of the following words in a logical and meaningful order. 1.Solar System 2.Earth 3.India 4.Asia 5.Milky way

(A) 5,1,2,4,3
(B) 1,2,3,4,5
(C) 5,4,3,2,1
(D) 2,1,3,4,5

Q.25

Three statements are given, followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some rains are cyclones. Some cyclones are draughts. No draught is a thunder. Conclusions: I. Some cyclones are rains. II. No thunder is a cyclone. III. No draught is a rain.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Only conclusion II follows
(C) Only conclusions I and III follow
(D) Only conclusions I and II follow

Quantitative Aptitude 17 questions

Q.1

A can do a piece of work in 15 days, but with the help of B, he can do it in 9 days. In what time can B do it alone?

(A) 22.5 days
(B) 18 days
(C) 21 days
(D) 20.5 days

Q.4

On buying 24 bangles Isha gets 6 bangles free of cost. What percent does Isha get as a discount?

(A) 25%
(B) 20%
(C) 10%
(D) 15%

Q.6

A shopkeeper mixes two qualities of rice, which cost him ₹40 per kg and ₹47.50 per kg respectively, in such a way that he has 15 kg of the blended rice costing him a total of ₹645. What is the weight (in kg) of the rice that cost him ₹47.50 per kg?

(A) 5
(B) 6
(C) 10
(D) 9

Q.7

A is the average marks of a group of 10 students in a class and A+8 is the average of a group of 15 students which includes the group of 10 students as given. The total marks obtained by the group of 10 students is X and the total marks obtained by the group of 15 students is Y. If X : Y = 3 : 5, then the value of A+X+Y is _____.

(A) 1964
(B) 1845
(C) 2012
(D) 1992

Q.8

Two trains leave Agra for Calcutta at 9:00 a.m. and 9:30 a.m., respectively, and travel at 240 km/h and 300 km/h, respectively. How many kilometres from Agra will the two trains meet?

(A) 270 km
(B) 300 km
(C) 600 km
(D) 240 km

Q.9

The identity $4(z + 7)(2z – 1) = Az^2 + Bz + C$ holds for all real values of z. Find the value of $A^2 – B – C$.

(A) –16
(B) 40
(C) 36
(D) 16

Q.10

Find the total surface area of a container in cylindrical shape whose diameter is 14 cm and height is 25 cm. [Use π = 22/7]

(A) 1452 cm^2
(B) 1392 cm^2
(C) 1408 cm^2
(D) 1424 cm^2

Q.13

A shopkeeper wanted to sell ₹3,000 worth of products. He gave two options — giving three successive discounts of 10% each, or giving a single discount of 30%. If a buyer chooses the former option how much extra/less does he pay as compared to the second option?

(A) ₹87 less
(B) ₹60 extra
(C) ₹87 extra
(D) ₹60 less

Q.14

At an election there were two candidates. A candidate got 38% of votes and lost by 7200 votes. The total number of valid votes is _____.

(A) 27360
(B) 30000
(C) 273600
(D) 3600

Q.15

If x=9, then the value of $x^5-10x^4+10x^3-10x^2+10x-1$ is:

(A) 10
(B) 8
(C) 9
(D) 1

Q.16

The third proportional of 42 and 63 is:

(A) 96.2
(B) 63.8
(C) 94.5
(D) 42.5

Q.17

A man travelled by car from city A to city B at a speed of 24 km/h and returned from city B to city A at 16 km/h. Find his average speed over the whole journey.

(A) 19.5 km/h
(B) 20 km/h
(C) 19 km/h
(D) 19.2 km/h

Q.18

A solid toy is in the shape which is a combination of a cylinder, cone and a hemispherical bowl. The cylinder contributes to 50% of the total volume of the toy, the cone contributes to 20% of the volume. Find the ratio of the contribution (in terms of volume) of the cone, cylinder and hemisphere.

(A) 2 : 3 : 5
(B) 5 : 2 : 3
(C) 2 : 5 : 3
(D) 4 : 5 : 3

Q.20

Find the area of the sector of a circle of radius 7 cm with a central angle of 90°.

(A) 38.50 cm^2
(B) 35 cm^2
(C) 20. 67 cm^2
(D) 28 cm^2

Q.21

If a company gives a discount of 20% on the marked price of an article and gains 20% on that particular article, then at what percentage above the cost price did the company mark its goods?

(A) 50%
(B) 20%
(C) 40%
(D) 25%

Q.22

The total surface area of a cuboid of length 90 cm, breadth 50 cm and height 4 m is:

(A) 18.15 m^2
(B) 1.21 m^2
(C) 6.05 m^2
(D) 12.1 m^2

Q.23

The average of the natural numbers divisible by 5 from the integers –10 to 35 is:

(A) –13.88
(B) 17.5
(C) 15
(D) 20

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

_____ is a world-renowned exponent of the Bansuri or bamboo flute.

(A) Anjanibai Malpekar
(B) Meera Banerjee
(C) Ajoy Chakrabarty
(D) Hari Prasad Chaurasia

Q.2

As of March 2021, with a throw of 88.07 m, javelin star Neeraj Chopra set a national record in the third Indian Grand Prix in _____.

(A) Jallandhar
(B) Bhatinda
(C) Patiala
(D) Ludhiana

Q.3

Which of the following freedom fighters wrote 'The Story of My Experiments with Truth'?

(A) BR Ambedkar
(B) Jawahar Lal Nehru
(C) Mahatma Gandhi
(D) Bhagat Singh

Q.4

Rajeev Taranath, a disciple of Ali Akbar Khan, is a _____ player.

(A) tabla
(B) Flute
(C) Sarod
(D) Santoor

Q.5

Kum Kum Mohanty received the Padma Shri award for her contribution to which of the following dance forms?

(A) Chhau
(B) Manipuri
(C) Bharatanatyam
(D) Odissi

Q.6

Which of the following angles of the flow of factor payments forms the basis to estimate the national income?

(A) Consumption angle
(B) Expenditure angle
(C) Income distribution angle
(D) Production angle

Q.7

'Straight from the Heart: An Autobiography' is the autobiography of which of the following Indian cricketers?

(A) Kapil Dev
(B) Sourav Ganguly
(C) Sachin Tendulkar
(D) Yuvraj Singh

Q.8

Which of the following cities will be the host of Summer Olympics 2028?

(A) Michigan
(B) Chicago
(C) New York
(D) Los Angeles

Q.9
In the case of Vikas KishanRao Gawali vs _____, in January 2021, the Supreme Court observed that OBC reservation cannot exceed 50%.

(A) State of Madhya Pradesh
(B) State of Maharashtra
(C) State of Goa
(D) State of Telangana

Q.10
Famous classical dancer Tanjore Balasaraswati was awarded the _____ in 1977.

(A) Padma Vibhushan
(B) Padma Bhushan
(C) Padma Shri
(D) Bharat Ratna

Q.11
How many seats of Rajya Sabha are present in the state of Maharashtra?

(A) 19
(B) 10
(C) 31
(D) 25

Q.12
Solanum lycopersicum L. is the scientific name of which of the following highly consumed vegetables?

(A) Potato
(B) Tomato
(C) Onion
(D) Garlic

Q.13
'Third man' is related to which of the following sports?

(A) Hockey
(B) Football
(C) Tennis
(D) Cricket

Q.14
How is the voltmeter connected across the points between which the potential difference is to be measured?

(A) Along the same magnetic field
(B) In parallel
(C) In concentric circles
(D) Perpendicular to each other

Q.15
As of June 2021, India men's football team captain _____ became the second-highest goal-scorer among the active international footballers.

(A) Anirudh Thapa
(B) Sahal Samad
(C) Sunil Chhetri
(D) Sandesh Jhingan

Q.16
Who among the following Indian Carnatic musicians received the Padma Vibhushan award in 1991 and established the Academy of Performing Arts and Research in Switzerland?

(A) Kishan Maharaj
(B) Dr. Mangalampalli Balamuralikrishna
(C) Ghulam Mustafa Khan
(D) Chhannulal Mishra

Q.17
Which outside layer of the Earth is less dense, thick, and andesitic to granite composition?

(A) Oceanic crust
(B) Continental crust
(C) Mantle
(D) Outer core

Q.18
Identify the solution extracted from a plant belonging to division Thallophyta.

(A) Turmeric solution
(B) Phenolphthalein solution
(C) Litmus solution
(D) Cabbage solution

Q.19

Titanium dioxide, which is used as a white pigment in products such as toothpaste, is derived from which mineral?

(A) Fluorite
(B) Ilmenite
(C) Silica
(D) Mica

Q.20

Soorya Classical Dance Festival is held in , _____ for 10 days every year.

(A) Rameshwaram
(B) Madurai
(C) Thiruvananthapuram
(D) Mysuru

Q.21

Kanaka Raju was awarded Padma Shri in 2021 for contribution to which of the following dance forms?

(A) Gussadi
(B) Chhau
(C) Sattriya
(D) Sadhir

Q.22

The electromagnetic spectrum describes the full range of light that is generally divided into _____ regions of wavelength and in the order of increasing energy and frequency.

(A) six
(B) eight
(C) seven
(D) Five

Q.23

Which artist's musical album is titled 'Land of Gold'?

(A) Mita Nag
(B) Anupama Bhagwat
(C) Anoushka Shankar
(D) Rajna Swaminathan

Q.24

Who among the following is the author of the famous classic 'Alice's Adventures in Wonderland'?

(A) Roald Dahl
(B) Ruskin Bond
(C) Lewis Carroll
(D) Ernest Hemingway

Q.25

Sandalwood is found in which type of forests in India?

(A) Tropical thorn forests and scrubs
(B) Tropical deciduous forests
(C) Mangrove forests
(D) Tropical evergreen forests

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**
Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(C)**	

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**
Q.16 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(B)**
Q.10 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**
Q.18 **(C)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (A) Quiet

'Clamour' is a loud, confused noise; its opposite is 'quiet'. 'Babble' is close to a synonym.

Q.3 · Answer (D) quiet

The word describes how the thief entered, so it must be the adverb 'quietly', not the adjective 'quiet'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) will believing him

The modal 'will' takes the base form of the verb: 'no one will believe him'.

Q.5 · Answer (D) made her feeble and unhappy

SSC's key gives 'made her feeble and unhappy': 'feeble and unhappy' keeps the sense of 'weak and sad', while 'ought to', 'had to' and 'must' add an obligation the sentence does not mean, and 'pallid' and 'pastel' describe colour. The original 'make' was itself acceptable; the key's change is to the simple past.

Q.6 · Answer (B) To like someone a lot

To 'have a soft spot for' someone is to be fond of them.

Q.7 · Answer (C) shrewd, targeted

A 'shrewd' (cleverly calculated) move, away from the places the robbers had earlier 'targeted'. 'Righteous' and 'noble' do not fit robbers, and 'vanished' cannot take an object.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Inspect

To 'reconnoitre' is to survey or inspect an area, usually to gather information.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Revoke

To 'rescind' an order or law is to cancel it officially: to 'revoke' it.

Q.10 · Answer (D) The police caught the thieves.

The simple past passive 'were caught by the police' becomes the simple past active, with the police as subject: 'The police caught the thieves.'

Q.11 · Answer (A) End something

To 'pull the plug' on something is to bring it to an end, typically by stopping its support.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Suspecious

The correct spelling is 'suspicious'.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Better behaviour is expected from a senior student.

'Expects' becomes 'is expected', with the object as subject, and the general agent 'one' is dropped: 'Better behaviour is expected from a senior student.'

Q.14 · Answer (A) ADCB

A opens with the Giant hearing music, D says what he took it to be, C says what it really was, and B follows with the Spring arriving: ADCB.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Disagreeing with

People 'at loggerheads' are in strong disagreement with each other.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Expedition

An expedition is a journey by a group for a particular purpose, such as exploration or research. A sojourn is a temporary stay, and a pilgrimage a journey to a holy place.

Q.18 · Answer (A) whole

'Whole' means entire: she could not eat the entire pizza. 'Hole' sounds the same but means an opening.

Q.19 · Answer (B) I was watching
An action in progress in the past, interrupted by another ('came'), takes the past continuous: 'I was watching a movie when my mother came into the room.'

Q.20 · Answer (B) posted over the wall
A notice is put up 'on' a wall, not 'over' it: 'posted on the wall'.

Q.21 · Answer (B) between
A contract is 'between' two parties: here the author and the reader.

Q.22 · Answer (B) of
One of the greatest inventions 'of' Western civilisation.

Q.23 · Answer (B) imaginary
Telling stories and inventing characters creates an 'imaginary' paradise.

Q.24 · Answer (D) because
The clause gives the reason no one can be expelled: 'because', in a novel, no one owns the truth.

Q.25 · Answer (C) heard
Everyone has the right to be 'heard' and understood.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (B) MHWDS
The letters move +1, −1, +1, −1, +1 in turn: PULSE → QTMRF and HEART → IDBQU. So LIVER → M H W D S: MHWDS.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Monday
From 13 September 2003 there are 17 + 31 + 30 + 31 = 109 days to the end of 2003, 366 in the leap year 2004 and 31 + 14 = 45 to 14 February 2005: 520 days. 520 = 74 × 7 + 2, so the day moves on 2 from Saturday: Monday.

Q.3 · Answer (D) QYEC
Each letter moves 2 places back (A wraps round to Y): GRAPES → EPYNCQ and ROSE → PMQC. So SAGE → QYEC.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 43
The second number is twice the first minus 1: 9 × 2 − 1 = 17 and 30 × 2 − 1 = 59. Likewise 22 × 2 − 1 = 43.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 82
Two series alternate: 67, 64, 61 (down 3) and 79, ?, 85 (up 3). The missing term is 79 + 3 = 82.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 82
The differences 24, 56, 88, 120, 152 grow by 32 each time: 2 + 24 = 26, 26 + 56 = 82, and 82 + 88 = 170.

Q.8 · Answer (B) 3153
Each term is three times the one before plus 1, 3, 5, 7, 9 in turn: 12 × 3 + 1 = 37, 37 × 3 + 3 = 114, 114 × 3 + 5 = 347, 347 × 3 + 7 = 1048, so 1048 × 3 + 9 = 3153.

Q.9 · Answer (A) ISHLENG
The last three letters come first, then the middle letter, then the first three: ABI L ITY → ITY L ABI and INS T EAD → EAD T INS. So ENG L ISH → ISH L ENG: ISHLENG.

Q.10 · Answer (D) 68
After replacing the letters: 15 + (3 × 9) − (12 × 2) + (189 ÷ 9) + 29 = 15 + 27 − 24 + 21 + 29 = 68.

Q.13 · Answer (C) M X B E R
With M, X, B, E, R in the blanks the series reads DMRXE CMRXE BMRXE AMRXE: the first letter moves back one each time and MRXE repeats.

Q.14 · Answer (A) 1223
Each term is 189 less than the one before: 1412 − 189 = 1223.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Fawn
A cub is a young bear and an owlet a young owl; a young deer is a fawn.

Q.16 · Answer (D) 131
The second number is the cube of one less than the first, plus the first: $3^3 + 4 = 31$ and $6^3 + 7 = 223$. Likewise $5^3 + 6 = 131$.

Q.18 · Answer (D) ÷,−,+, ×, =
16 ÷ 4 − 8 + 10 × 2 = 16: 16 ÷ 4 = 4 and 10 × 2 = 20, so 4 − 8 + 20 = 16.

Q.19 · Answer (A) JXMZ
First letters move back 4 (R, N, J, F, B), second letters forward 7 (J, Q, X, E, L), third letters back 10 (G, W, M, C, S), wrapping round the alphabet, and the fourth letters alternate Z, M: JXMZ.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 645
Each term is 109 more than the one before: 536 + 109 = 645, and 645 + 109 = 754.

Q.23 · Answer (D) ÷,+,×,=,×,−
48 ÷ 6 + 17 × 3 = 12 × 5 − 1: the left side is 8 + 51 = 59 and the right side 60 − 1 = 59.

Q.24 · Answer (A) 5,1,2,4,3
From the largest to the smallest: the Milky Way contains the Solar System, which contains the Earth, on which lies Asia, which contains India: 5, 1, 2, 4, 3.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Only conclusion I follows
'Some rains are cyclones' can be reversed: some cyclones are rains (I). The statements only show that the cyclones that are draughts are not thunders, so II is not certain, and nothing links draughts to rains, so III is not certain either.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (A) 22.5 days
B does 1/9 − 1/15 = 2/45 of the work a day, so B alone takes 45/2 = 22.5 days.

Q.4 · Answer (B) 20%
She takes 30 bangles for the price of 24, so the discount is 6/30 = 20%.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 6
With x kg at ₹47.50: 40(15 − x) + 47.5x = 645, so 600 + 7.5x = 645 and x = 6.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 1992
X = 10A and Y = 15(A + 8). 5X = 3Y gives 50A = 45A + 360, so A = 72, X = 720 and Y = 1,200: A + X + Y = 1,992.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 600 km
By 9:30 a.m. the first train is 120 km ahead, and the second gains 60 km/h on it, so it catches up in 2 hours, at 11:30 a.m. The first train has then run for 2.5 hours: 240 × 2.5 = 600 km.

Q.9 · Answer (B) 40
$4(z + 7)(2z − 1) = 4(2z^2 + 13z − 7) = 8z^2 + 52z − 28$, so A = 8, B = 52 and C = −28. $A^2 − B − C = 64 − 52 + 28 = 40$.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 1408 cm²
Total surface area = $2\pi r(r + h) = 2 \times 22/7 \times 7 \times (7 + 25) = 44 \times 32 = 1{,}408$ cm².

Q.13 · Answer (C) ₹87 extra
Three 10% discounts leave $0.9^3 = 0.729$ of the price, ₹2,187; a single 30% discount leaves ₹2,100. The buyer pays ₹87 extra.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 30000
The winner got 62%, so the margin is 62% − 38% = 24% of the valid votes = 7,200. Valid votes = 7,200 ÷ 0.24 = 30,000.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 8
With $x = 9$, $10 = x + 1$, so the expression is $x^5 - (x + 1)x^4 + (x + 1)x^3 - (x + 1)x^2 + (x + 1)x - 1$. The terms cancel in pairs, leaving $x - 1 = 8$.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 94.5
The third proportional of a and b is $b^2/a = 63^2/42 = 3{,}969/42 = 94.5$.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 19.2 km/h
Over equal distances the average speed is $2uv/(u + v) = 2 \times 24 \times 16/40 = 19.2$ km/h.

Q.18 · Answer (C) 2 : 5 : 3
The hemisphere makes up the remaining 100 − 50 − 20 = 30% of the volume. Cone : cylinder : hemisphere = 20 : 50 : 30 = 2 : 5 : 3.

Q.20 · Answer (A) 38.50 cm²
A 90° sector is a quarter of the circle: $(1/4) \times 22/7 \times 7^2 = 154/4 = 38.5$ cm².

Q.21 · Answer (A) 50%
Take the cost as 100: the selling price is 120, which is 80% of the marked price, so the marked price is 150, 50% above cost.

Q.22 · Answer (D) 12.1 m²
In metres, $l = 0.9$, $b = 0.5$ and $h = 4$: $2(lb + bh + hl) = 2(0.45 + 2 + 3.6) = 2 \times 6.05 = 12.1$ m².

Q.23 · Answer (D) 20
The natural numbers in the range divisible by 5 are 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30 and 35 (0, −5 and −10 are not natural numbers). Their average is $(5 + 35)/2 = 20$.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Hari Prasad Chaurasia
Hariprasad Chaurasia is India's best-known bansuri (bamboo flute) player; Anjanibai Malpekar and Ajoy Chakrabarty are vocalists.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Patiala
Neeraj Chopra threw 88.07 m at the third Indian Grand Prix at Patiala in March 2021, bettering his own national record of 88.06 m set at the 2018 Asian Games.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Mahatma Gandhi
'The Story of My Experiments with Truth' is Mahatma Gandhi's autobiography, written first in Gujarati.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Sarod
Rajeev Taranath is a sarod player, a disciple of the sarod master Ali Akbar Khan.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Odissi
Kumkum Mohanty is a leading Odissi dancer from Odisha.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Income distribution angle
Factor payments (rent, wages, interest and profit) are the incomes earned by the factors of production, so adding up their flow is the income, or income distribution, method of estimating national income.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Kapil Dev
'Straight from the Heart' is the autobiography of Kapil Dev, who led India to the 1983 World Cup.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Los Angeles
Los Angeles will host the 2028 Summer Olympics, its third after 1932 and 1984.

Q.9 · Answer (B) State of Maharashtra
The case was about OBC reservation in Maharashtra's local bodies; the Supreme Court held that reservation for SCs, STs and OBCs there together cannot exceed 50%.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Padma Vibhushan
T. Balasaraswati, the great Bharatanatyam dancer, received the Padma Vibhushan in 1977; she had received the Padma Bhushan in 1957.

Q.11 · Answer (A) 19
Maharashtra has 19 Rajya Sabha seats, the second most after Uttar Pradesh's 31.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Tomato
Solanum lycopersicum is the tomato, of the same genus as the potato (Solanum tuberosum).

Q.13 · Answer (D) Cricket
Third man is a fielding position in cricket, behind the slips on the off side.

Q.14 · Answer (B) In parallel
A voltmeter is connected in parallel across the two points, so that it has the same potential difference as they do; an ammeter is connected in series.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Sunil Chhetri
Sunil Chhetri's two goals against Bangladesh in June 2021 took him to 74, past Lionel Messi and second only to Cristiano Ronaldo among active players.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Dr. Mangalampalli Balamuralikrishna
M. Balamuralikrishna, the Carnatic vocalist, received the Padma Vibhushan in 1991. Kishan Maharaj, Ghulam Mustafa Khan and Chhannulal Mishra are Hindustani musicians.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Continental crust
The continental crust is thicker and less dense than the oceanic crust, and broadly granitic in composition; the oceanic crust is basaltic.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Litmus solution
Litmus is extracted from lichens, which NCERT places in the division Thallophyta.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Ilmenite
Titanium dioxide is obtained mainly from the titanium minerals ilmenite ($FeTiO_3$) and rutile.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Thiruvananthapuram
The Soorya Classical Dance Festival is held every year in Thiruvananthapuram, the capital of Kerala.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Gussadi
Kanaka Raju of Telangana received the Padma Shri in 2021 for Gussadi, the dance of the Raj Gond community.

Q.22 · Answer (C) seven
The seven regions, in order of increasing energy and frequency, are radio waves, microwaves, infrared, visible light, ultraviolet, X-rays and gamma rays.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Anoushka Shankar
'Land of Gold' (2016) is an album by the sitar player Anoushka Shankar.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Lewis Carroll
'Alice's Adventures in Wonderland' (1865) was written by Lewis Carroll, the pen name of Charles Dodgson.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Tropical deciduous forests
NCERT lists sandalwood among the trees of the tropical deciduous forests, with teak, sal, shisham and khair.

This paper online, with tap-to-reveal answers: https://parikshasaathi.com/exams/ssc-chsl/question-papers/chsl-2021-tier-i-30-may-2022-shift-2/

Every solved SSC CHSL paper: https://parikshasaathi.com/exams/ssc-chsl/question-papers/

Daily current affairs PDF, free, every morning on Telegram: t.me/parikshasaathiapp

Questions and official answers: the Staff Selection Commission (SSC). Explanations: drafted with AI assistance by Pariksha Saathi and checked against the official answers. Pariksha Saathi is not affiliated with any exam body. Spotted an error? Write to sriwastava2@gmail.com.